

AuthorVAULT feedback III

Need the new logo in the top left corner.

The overall color needs to be ScribeCount blue. The light blue that's in the logo.

DASHBOARD:

I like the Dashboard page. I got some feedback from other authors, and it was 50/50 on whether the tiles should be links. Let's keep it the way it is.

The little house icons for the Publishing company, imprints, and Pen Names. Can those be avatars?

COMPANY:

Little building Icon. Need that to be an avatar too.

There's very little that I DON'T like about the page you made here. It has everything I asked for and things I didn't think of. So well done there.

Ownership and Management.

I like the layout. I don't see a way to change or load files to where they go (Documents per person) so I'm assuming that is still in development.

I like the security features. The four-digit pin is great, but it needs to time out after ten minutes.

Corporate and Legal

I like the hidden Tax ID numbers with the button to expose. Can we give that a timer too? (When I look at things like this, I just imagine myself working in a coffee shop with people walking past, it helps to expose where things like this are needed)

We need to make sure the copyright link can be changed as not all of our authors will be in the US, but defaulting to the US office is good.

Banking

This is good. Well done.

Tax Information

I like this as well. One question. Anytime there is an email address can we make that clickable and integrated with SC Email so they can jump to that and send an email?

I didn't think of resale certs, nice catch.

Publishing Platforms

This is good. I wish I could click on it and play with it, but that's ok. Seeingt his makes me wonder if we can have a form of automated Password update feature, but I'm not going to add anything to your list at this point. If you could let me know if that's possible though, I'll explore it later. The only thing I would add here is a place for them to keep the name and contact information of their account rep at each platform.

Account Representative:

Contact Email:

Account ID number:

Most authors don't have a rep, so we should place the customer service link/information there.

ISBN's

Everyone had an opinion on this, and after a lot of talk they all agreed there is no perfect way to do this. So we're not going to change it. I think you've covered everything with the search functions and filters. We'll no doubt get a lot of feedback after we launch and we can maybe revisit this then, but for now we stay with what you have.

Contracts

I think this is fine as well. One question: The Categories section at the bottom; is that a search function that shows existing contracts by category, or is that a list of sample contracts they can edit to fit their own needs?

It would be nice to have sample contracts that they can open, edit, and email right from AuthorVAULT. I see "TEMPLATE" in the top tile, so I may have answered my own question here.

Financial Records

This is fine. I view it as a storage file for historical reports, so it looks good for that.

Same question here about the document categories as I had in the Contracts section.

Team and Vendors

Good, buty it appears to be off the page on my screen. May be formatting, may be my curved monitor messing with me. I can't close the sidebar?? Maybe that is doing it? Wait, the button is all the way at the bottom. Let's change that to the top.

Regardless, good tile. I like the links out. Same questions about the “Vendor Categories” tile content. Should that be a dropdown menu at the top??

Websites and Domains

Love this. Probably because I need it myself.

Communications

I like this. Maybe hide some of the sensitive stuff.

Inventory

I don’t ship from my own address or warehouse so I’m going to get some feedback on this from some authors who do. For now its fine. I like that you added it and it will become a much bigger thing when we add the Publishers Dashboard later.

Security and Recovery

This is good. One of those places where you wonder what all to include. I have a feeling we’ll be adding to this, but for now, let's go with what you have.

Logo’s

This is fine. As long as they can load, label, and find what they need fast, it’ll make things a lot easier to retrieve.

SOP’s

I like this. I feel it needs a filter. Do we have a library of samples to add here?

IMPRINTS

This is good. Simple like I asked for and easy to understand. Need to do the avatar thing here. (I know this seems like a minor thing but it goes to “customization” as in the more they can make the page and features “theirs” the more entrenched they become in the OS.

Company File, Imprints, ISBN’s are all the same as I’ve mentioned already, so I’ll skip them here.

Calendar

Love this. Especially the dropdown/filter. But, can we have the option of seeing an actual calendar? Monthly, Quarterly, Yearly.

LIBRARY

Pen Names

Avatars.

Identity

This is good. I'd make sure they can add several genres and sub-genres. I'd also add a "notes" section.

Branding and Assets

Perfect.

Platforms

Here's where we start conflicting with other areas. Do we save the account access info here, or back in the publishing company info? Both? For now lets keep it as you have it here. I'll see what kind of feedback we get before we make any changes.

Online Presence

This is good. I think we'll be okay as long as they can add things. That includes both a Platform and an address. Authors have groups that range from little local book clubs all the way up to giant YouTube subscribers, so we'll need a way for them to add whatever they want.

Reader Community

This overlaps with Online Presence a lot, but I think you've done well separating them here. Let's leave this as it is and get some feedback before we make any changes.

SERIES

Identity

Let's change that to "Series Name"

I like this tile. I can't think of anything I would add here so lets keep it simple until we get some good suggestions on any changes.

Books

With our "Keep it Simple" goal I think this is fine.

World

This is something I've been thinking about a bit. Book bible. Character Codex. Timelines. These are things that authors struggle to remember accurately. Especially fantasy authors with a zillion characters with weird names and powers and histories.

I'm wondering if we might add some AI to this and have it create those files for them from an uploaded manuscript. Or if we just keep it as we have it now and watch to see how they use it. They can create those files themselves and upload them. We'll just need to have our AI feature read it all and be able to answer questions pertaining to it. "What was Adria's eye color?", "Who was Ankita's secret brother in book 4?" That kind of thing.

For now, let's treat this as a file storage for them to load what they want.

Branding

This is good. No changes.

Box Sets

There's nothing here so I can't really provide any feedback. Box sets are a format, so they get their own ISBN's and all the related metadata and blurbs and everything else a standard book would get.

That's all I have.

I like that you have built this with the Digital Assistant in mind. It'll make that integration easier later. I picture us adding things to this based on user feedback as no file system ever fits everyone's needs. The end goal here was to meet or beat Dropbox and do so in a way that serves authors specifically. I think you've done that very well.

We'll be marketing this along three themes:

1. It's FREE, as in it comes with their ScribeCount subscription.
2. It's searchable, safe, customizable, and easy to use.
3. It's integrated with all of their other ScribeCount features, especially email and marketing assets.

The best thing for SC is the sunk cost. Once they have everything in AuthorVAULT and have used the integrations a few times, leaving becomes very painful.

I think we're very very close to having a finished UI. My stress level has come down a notch.

Any questions, I'm here.

Randall